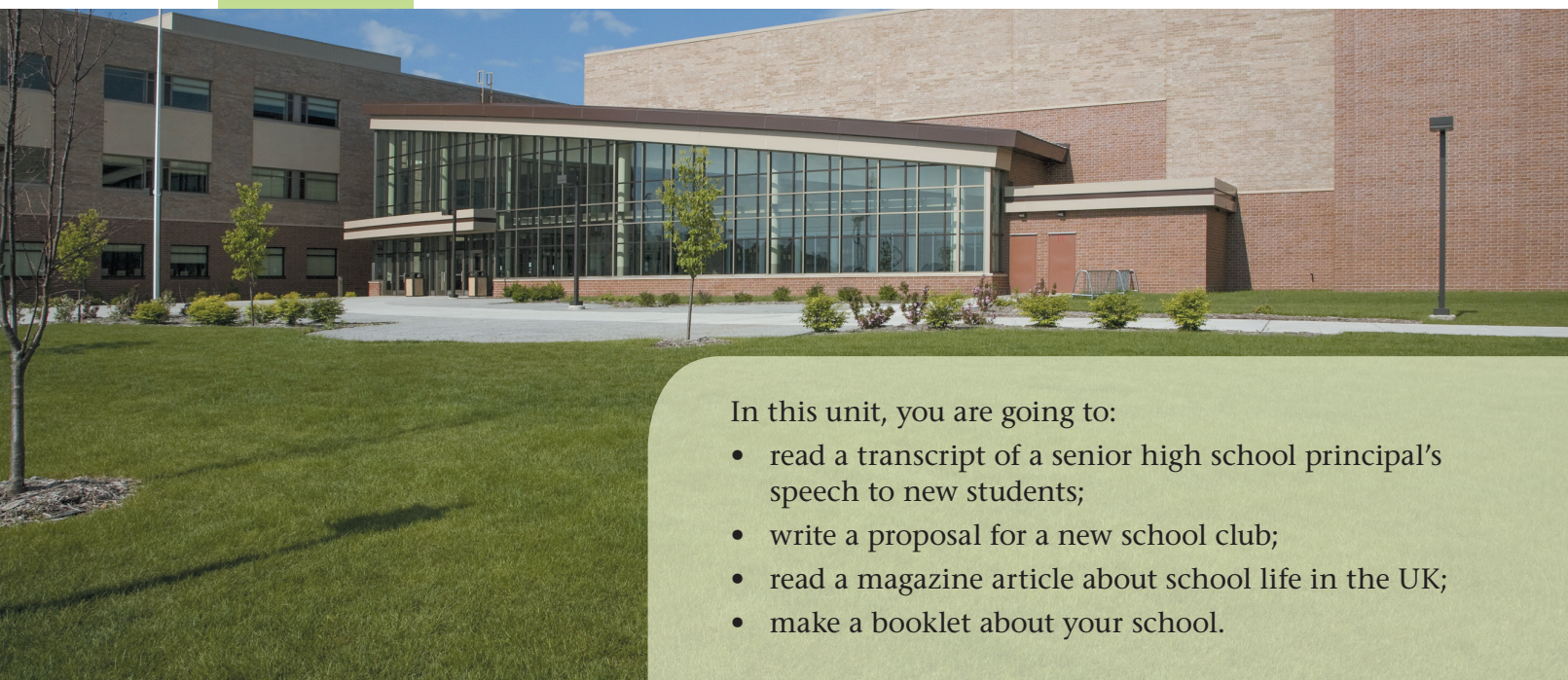


UNIT 1

Back to school

Study without thinking leads to confusion; thinking without study ends in puzzlement.

—Confucius



In this unit, you are going to:

- read a transcript of a senior high school principal's speech to new students;
- write a proposal for a new school club;
- read a magazine article about school life in the UK;
- make a booklet about your school.

Welcome to the unit



Senior high school is a time of learning and discovery. Watch the video and finish the following exercises.



Wendy:

- feels a bit nervous;
- plans to work harder in her studies and join the _____.

Stephen:

- feels _____;
- plans to spend more time on _____.

- 1 What do you think of your new school life so far?
- 2 In what areas do you think you can do well at senior high school? In what areas will you have to work harder?

Reading



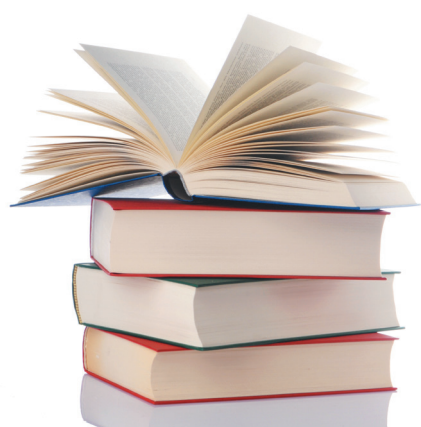
Senior high school brings a lot of new experiences to everyone. The speech below was given to new senior high school students by their principal, Mr Xu, on the first day of term. Before you read the speech transcript, think about the following questions:

- How do you think senior high school will be different from junior high school?
- What do you think the principal will talk about in his speech?



Hello, everyone! Welcome to senior high school! Today is the start of a new term, the start of a three-year journey and the start of a promising future.

I can't wait to describe to you what senior high school
5 life is like. The path before you leads to a world full
of challenges: a new environment, new knowledge
and new ways of thinking. However, for those of
you with a positive mind, opportunity lies in each
challenge. When you rise to the challenges, you will
10 have the opportunity to acquire great knowledge and
enjoy personal growth. Most importantly, your time
and effort at senior high school will open the door to
your potential.



“What is potential?” you may ask. Put simply, potential is your natural ability that
15 can be developed when you try hard enough. Who knows what beautiful works
of art you will create, what medical advances you will make or what amazing
technologies you will develop! The possibilities are endless, and I have confidence
in your ability to make a difference to your family, to your community and to
our country. Over the next three years, you will discover your potential while you
20 develop as a student and as a person.

To fully realize your potential, it is important for you to make the most of our
school resources. Take advantage of your classes, learn from your teachers and
classmates, and make use of our school facilities. There are also a lot of school
activities for you. Join a club or two, and take an active part in different sports.

25 Of equal importance are good study habits, useful skills and a positive attitude.
Carefully plan your study, set clear goals and balance your schoolwork with other
activities. As a senior high school student, you must make efforts to improve your
communication and problem-solving skills. Last but not least, always look on the
bright side and never lose hope, even in difficult situations. In time you will find
30 yourself growing into a well-rounded individual.

As Lao-Tzu wisely said, “A journey of a thousand miles begins with a single
step.” You need to make a continuous effort to train your mind and develop your
character. Senior high school will help you learn and grow, yet you alone are
responsible for realizing your great potential. Be confident, do your best and make
35 us proud!



A Understanding the text

A1 Read the speech transcript and find the topic sentence for each paragraph.

Para. 1: Welcome to senior high school!

Para. 2: _____

Para. 3: _____

Para. 4: _____

Para. 5: _____

Para. 6: _____

Tip

Finding topic sentences

A topic sentence tells the reader the main idea of a paragraph. It is usually at the beginning of a paragraph, but it may also be in the middle or at the end of a paragraph.

A2 Read the speech transcript again carefully and answer the following questions.

1 What challenges will students face at senior high school?

2 What does the principal have confidence in?

3 What school resources are mentioned in the speech?

4 What positive attitude should students develop?

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1 How does the principal try to keep his audience interested? What rhetorical devices does he use? Find examples from the speech.

2 How are you going to realize your potential?

Tip

Understanding a speech

A speech is a formal talk that a person gives to an audience. A good speech keeps the audience interested all the time. To achieve this, the speaker may tell interesting stories or ask questions. A good speech also uses quotations and such rhetorical devices as metaphor, repetition and parallelism.

B Building your language

B1 Maggie, a new student, wrote about her first day at senior high school. Complete the passage with the correct forms of the words and phrases in the box below.

challenge	confidence	acquire	rise to
effort	responsible	balance	take advantage of

I've just finished my first day of senior high school and I really enjoyed it. I've been told that schoolwork will present more of a(n) (1) _____ in the years ahead, and that the teachers will hold us to higher standards. This means I'll have to put a lot of (2) _____ into my studies. I'll also need to be very careful about (3) _____ my schoolwork and hobbies. This is all quite new and different from my life at junior high school, but I'm sure I'll (4) _____ all these challenges. In fact, I'm looking forward to being more independent and (5) _____ for my own learning. There is so much knowledge I need to (6) _____, so I'll work harder than ever. I also plan to (7) _____ every opportunity to improve my communication skills. I'll make more friends by joining some clubs. I have (8) _____ in my ability to do well at senior high school!

B2 The speech uses some adjectives. Note the following suffixes and think of more adjectives formed with them. Then fill in the table below with as many words as you can.

Parts of speech	Suffixes	Words
Nouns	-ful	useful
	-less	endless
	-al	natural
Verbs	-ive	active
	-ous	continuous

Tip

Forming adjectives with suffixes

We can form adjectives by adding suffixes to nouns or verbs. Sometimes we need to leave out or change the final letter(s) of a word before adding a suffix, e.g. centre→central, decide→decisive.

B3 The speech uses a number of parallel structures. Find them in the speech and use a similar structure to encourage someone who is unhappy.

Learn this Parallel structures use the same pattern of words or sentences. They can add balance to sentences and make the language more powerful and effective.

Grammar and usage

Sentence elements and sentence structures

A Exploring the rules

On the first day of school, Miss Yan gave a short speech about the importance of setting goals. Pay attention to the underlined sentences and fill in the table below. The first one has been done for you.

Albert Einstein said, "If you want to live a happy life, tie it to a goal." ⁽¹⁾ I agree. Goals are important in many ways. ⁽²⁾ Setting goals gives you a focus in life. By setting goals now, you are deciding what you want to achieve in the future. Then you know where you are going in life and can work hard to get there. Setting goals also helps you develop good habits. To realize your goals, you need to have a good plan, manage your time well and pay attention to details. ⁽³⁾ These habits will be helpful. Finally, ⁽⁴⁾ setting goals makes you more confident. When you achieve a goal, you see the result of your hard work and know how much progress you have made. A goal is a dream that needs action. As a result of your action, your dream will come true and hopefully ⁽⁵⁾ you will live a happy life.

Subject	Verb		
I	agree.		
Subject	Verb	Predicative	
Subject	Verb	Object	
Subject	Verb	Indirect object	Direct object
Subject	Verb	Object	Object complement

Working out the rules

- The subject and the ⁽¹⁾ _____ are necessary parts of a sentence.
- A transitive verb is always followed by a(n) ⁽²⁾ _____.
- Some verbs can have two objects. The indirect object usually refers to a person and the direct object a thing.
- The object complement adds more information about the object.

👉 Grammar notes → pages 96–97

B Applying the rules

B1 Mark the different elements of each sentence with different symbols. Use the example below to help you.

Subject: ____

Verb: ==

Object: ~~~~

Predicative: ~~~~

Object complement: ~~~~

Adverbial: []

Attributive: ()

Example

You will enjoy (personal) growth [at (high) school].

- 1 You will find senior high school different from junior high school.
- 2 Your schoolwork will be more challenging.
- 3 We will give you more independence.
- 4 You should listen more carefully.
- 5 You can join a club.
- 6 Your teachers will help you in many ways.
- 7 You will succeed!

B2 Below are some tips about setting goals. Match the underlined sentences with the correct structures. Write the letters in the boxes.

a SV

b SVP

c SVO

d SVOO

e SVOC

f SVA

g SVOA

Setting goals is the first step in achieving them. (1) The tips below may help you. ☐

Set goals that can be achieved. Don't push yourself to achieve more than what is possible. Instead, you should set goals based on your abilities and skills.

Break big goals down into small ones. When you do so, (2) they will seem easier to reach. ☐ You will be proud of yourself when you realize each small goal. (3) This will also give you the encouragement to achieve your long-term goal. ☐

Write your goals on paper. It is a good idea to put your goals where you can see them. (4) You can place the list on your bedside table. ☐ Or you can stick it on your bedroom wall. This will remind you of what you are working for and keep you focused.

After you set a goal, it is important to stick to it and work hard towards it. (5) You may find achieving goals difficult. ☐ But (6) you should not give up. ☐ Instead, stay positive and confident. (7) You will succeed in the end. ☐

B3 What is your goal for the new term? How are you going to achieve your goal? Write about it using different sentence structures. Use the example below to help you.

Example

I will try to improve my English in the new term. There are a lot of things I need to do to achieve this goal. I will read two English novels this term. I will also try to find a language partner. Joining the English Club will be helpful to me too. All my efforts will pay off!

Integrated skills

Starting a new school club

A Maggie is talking to Mr Zhou about starting a new school club. Listen and finish the exercises below.



A1 Listen to Maggie and Mr Zhou's conversation and put the steps it takes to start a new school club in the correct order. Write the letters in the boxes.

- a** Give the signed proposal to Mr Zhou.
- b** With Mr Zhou's help, find a place for the club and set up the first meeting.
- c** Write a proposal for the new club.
- d** Wait for the proposal to be accepted by the principal.
- e** Find at least five students to sign up for the first meeting.



A2 Listen to Maggie and Mr Zhou's conversation again and complete the notes below.

Maggie's new school club

- **Purpose of starting a new club**
To help students (1) _____
- **Type of club Maggie wants to start**
A (2) _____ club
- **Information the proposal must contain**
 - The name of the club
 - The name of the (3) _____
 - The aims of the club
 - The time the club will meet every week
 - The (4) _____ Maggie plans to organize
 - What materials she will need
 - How she is going to (5) _____

B After her conversation with Mr Zhou, Maggie wrote a proposal for a new school club. Read her proposal below and try to understand its structure.

Proposal for a new club

Club name: Short Story Writing Club

Club leader: Maggie Zhang

Meeting time: Friday afternoon from 4:30 to 5:30

Club aim: To improve short story writing skills

Club activities:

- Read short stories in different styles;
- Write short stories using different techniques;
- Hold workshops to discuss the short stories that club members read and write;
- Invite professional writers to give talks on short story writing.

Materials needed: Paper and pen for each student

Plan for finding new members:

- Make posters and put them up around the school;
- Put a notice in the school newspaper and on the school website;
- Put a video on the school website.

Signed: Maggie Zhang



C In pairs, talk about starting a new school club. Use the following ideas and expressions to help you.

- The type of club you want to start
- The aims of the club
- The activities you plan to do at the club
- The materials you will need
- The ways to find new members

Expressions

Talking about plans

We'd like to start a ... club in order to .../so that ...

We plan/intend to ... by ...

Our plan for a ... club calls for ...

Our club aims to/is intended to ...

D Write your proposal for a new school club. Use your ideas from part C and the information in parts A and B to help you.

Planning your writing

• Learning about the text type

A proposal is a formal suggestion or plan. Its purpose is to get the reader to agree to your suggestion or plan.

• Learning about the structure

It is important to separate different types of information to make your proposal easy to read. Refer to page 9 to see how you should structure your proposal.

• Learning about the language

The target reader of your proposal is your school principal. Use formal language and provide important and brief information about your suggestion or plan.

Checking your writing

It is important to check your writing after you finish. You should especially check if there are any mistakes in terms of:

☐ Punctuation

☐ Spelling

☐ Grammar

☐ Choice of words

☐ Style (formal/informal)

☐ Structure

It is a good idea to work in pairs to read and edit each other's writing. You should give different types of comments, including praise, suggestions and corrections.

Self-review

- What mistakes do you find in your writing?
- How can you correct them?

Peer review

- What comments does your partner give on your writing?
- How can you improve your writing?

Extended reading



John Li, a Chinese senior high school student, has spent a year studying in the UK. Read his article in the school magazine about his school life abroad.

School life in the UK



Last year, I had the chance to study at a British secondary school as an exchange student. I stayed with a lovely host family and went to school with their son, Daniel. We were both in year ten and we got on well. He is learning Chinese and will come to stay with me this year in China!

5 The British school day commonly begins around 9 a.m. and ends around 4 p.m. Every secondary school student in the UK must study English, Maths and the Science subjects: Biology, Chemistry and Physics. In year ten, students usually have to learn nine subjects and they can also choose to study other subjects, such as History, Art and Business.

10 The classes are different from those in China. Each teacher has their own classroom and the students move around for every lesson. In most of my classes, there were only about 20 students. In the beginning, however, it was still tough for me to remember everyone's name!

I enjoyed most of the classes, but some of them were quite challenging. Technology
15 classes were fun. I made a clock to take home. The teacher helped me put the parts together. I like it so much that I still use it as my alarm! I found Maths quite easy and enjoyable because the material was less advanced in the UK than in China. However, learning in English was a great challenge for me. There were a lot of difficult English words, especially in Geography and Biology. Class discussion
20 is very important in the UK, but I could not make a great contribution because sometimes I wasn't able to express myself clearly in English. Although there was not as much homework as I was used to, it was still challenging. Fortunately, my

teachers and classmates were always helpful and gave me lots of encouragement. My language skills improved over time.

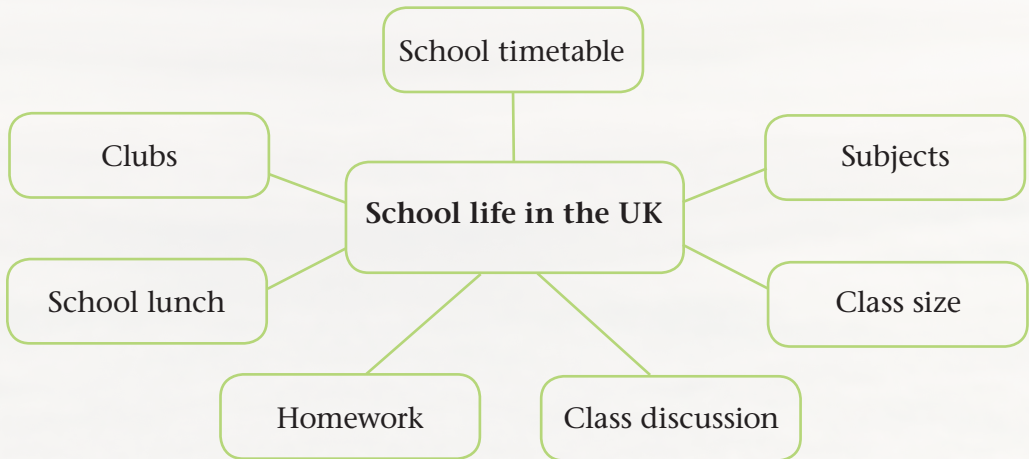
25 During the hour-long lunchtime, I ate in the school dining hall. There were lots of options including bread and butter, chicken pie and puddings, but I still missed my mum’s cooking! After lunch, I often played on the school’s huge sports field with Daniel and his friends. Sometimes we just relaxed under a tree or sat on the grass.

After school, there were many clubs to join. The
30 one that attracted me most was the Rugby Club. We played once a week, and it was great fun. Also, I enjoyed acting in the Theatre Club. I still have photos of myself acting in William Shakespeare’s *A Midsummer*
35 *Night’s Dream*. Joining clubs was a great way to meet British students and make friends with them.



I am glad to have the opportunity to experience this different way of life. I met some great people and learnt a lot about school life in the UK. Daniel and his family were fantastic hosts, and his friends were very nice as well. I can’t wait for
40 Daniel to visit China!

A What is school life in the UK like? Look at the mind map below and find information from the passage. Then think about what school life in China is like.



B What is your dream school like? Write about it and give reasons.

Project

Making a booklet about your school

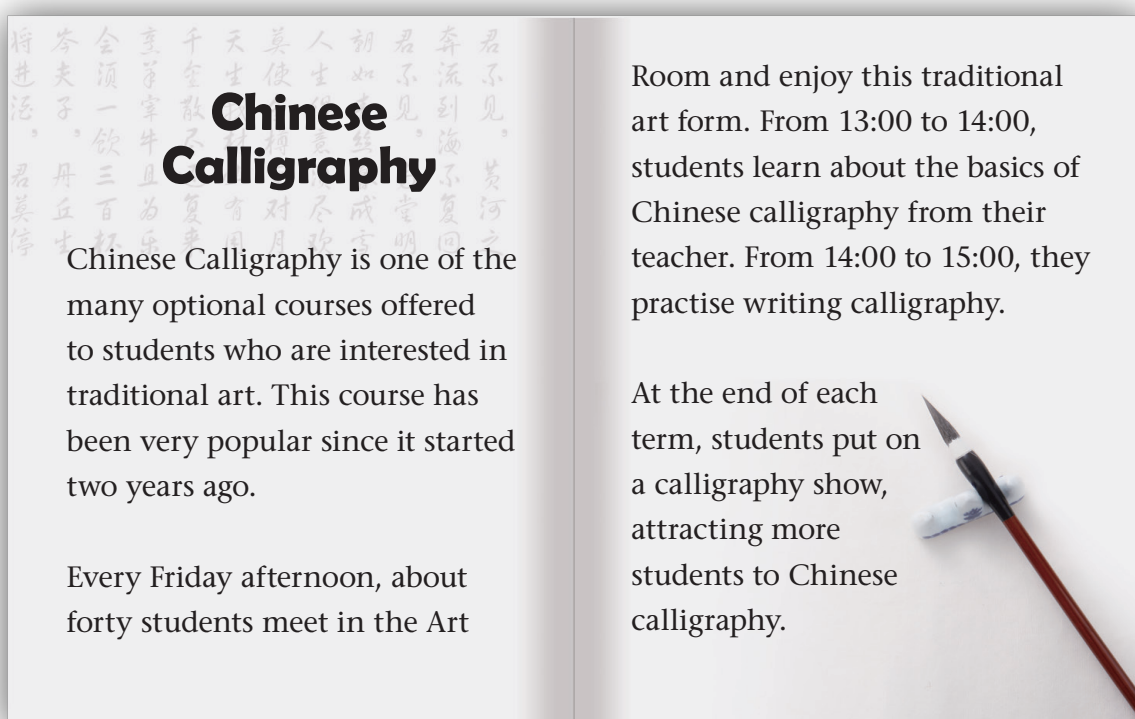
A As a class, discuss different aspects about your school. You can use the ideas below or think of other ideas. Then in groups, pick one aspect to research.

lessons	teachers	school history	school events
clubs	teaching buildings	labs	library
computer room	...		

B As a group, research your chosen aspect. Use the ideas below to help you.

- Where can you find the information you need?
You can visit the school website or interview your teachers to find out more about your school.
- What kind of questions should you ask when interviewing a teacher?
It is a good idea to start with general questions and then move on to specific ones, e.g.
Can you tell me something about the history of our school? (general)
When was the main teaching building built? (specific)
- What else do you need for your booklet?
Besides words, you also need pictures for your booklet. You can take photos or download pictures from your school website. Make sure all words and pictures are laid out neatly and beautifully.

C As a group, put together your information to make your part of the booklet. Use the example below to help you. Present your part to the rest of the class. Then as a class, put all the parts together to make the booklet.



UNIT 2

Let's talk teens

I don't know what "home" is, but unhappiness and worries melt away once there.

—Bing Xin



In this unit, you are going to:

- read a magazine article about relationships between teenagers and their parents;
- write a letter of advice on parent-child tensions;
- read a short story of a mother's love for her children;
- create a short play about parent-child relationships.

Welcome to the unit



Parents often give their children unconditional love. Read the poem below and discuss the following questions in pairs.

Morning and night, Mother Bird is there
Until her baby's old enough to leave the nest.
Mother Bird, with all her love and care,
Longs to provide her baby with the best.
Often, she worries, from day to day—
Very soon her baby will be full-grown.
Excitedly, it will jump away,
Spread its wings and fly alone.
Yet, she knows, she must let it fly
Over the hills and across the sky,
Under her careful, watching eye.



- 1 How would you describe Mother Bird's feelings in the poem?
- 2 What Chinese poems about parents' love for their children can you think of?
- 3 How do you think your parents feel about you? How can you tell?

Reading



When teenagers' bodies and minds go through a period of rapid development, every part of their lives can be influenced. The magazine article below is about teenagers' relationships with their parents. Before you read the article, think about the following questions:

- What physical and mental changes do you experience as you become a teenager? How do you deal with them?
- What do you think "strangers under the same roof" means?

Strangers under the same roof?



Does every dinner with your parents seem to turn into a battle? Have your once warm and open conversations become cold and guarded? Do you feel that you just cannot see eye to eye with them on anything? You
5 are not alone. Heated arguments and cold silences are common between teenagers and their parents.

Teenagers' physical changes may result in such family tensions. You may feel anxious that you are developing at a different rate to your friends, shooting up in height
10 or getting left far behind. You might worry about your changing voice, weight problems or spots. When it all gets too much, your parents are often the first targets of your anger.

It can be a big headache to balance your developing
15 mental needs too. You enter a strange middle ground—

no longer a small child but not quite an adult. You have both a new desire for independence and a continued need for your parents' love and support. You feel ready to be more responsible and make decisions on your own. Unfortunately, your parents do not always agree and that makes you feel unhappy. "Why can't they just let me go?" you may wonder. On the other hand, when you are struggling to control your feelings, you wish they could be more caring and patient—sometimes they forget that growing up is a rough ride. It can be difficult when your parents treat you like a child but expect you to act like an adult. All of this can lead to a breakdown in your relationship.

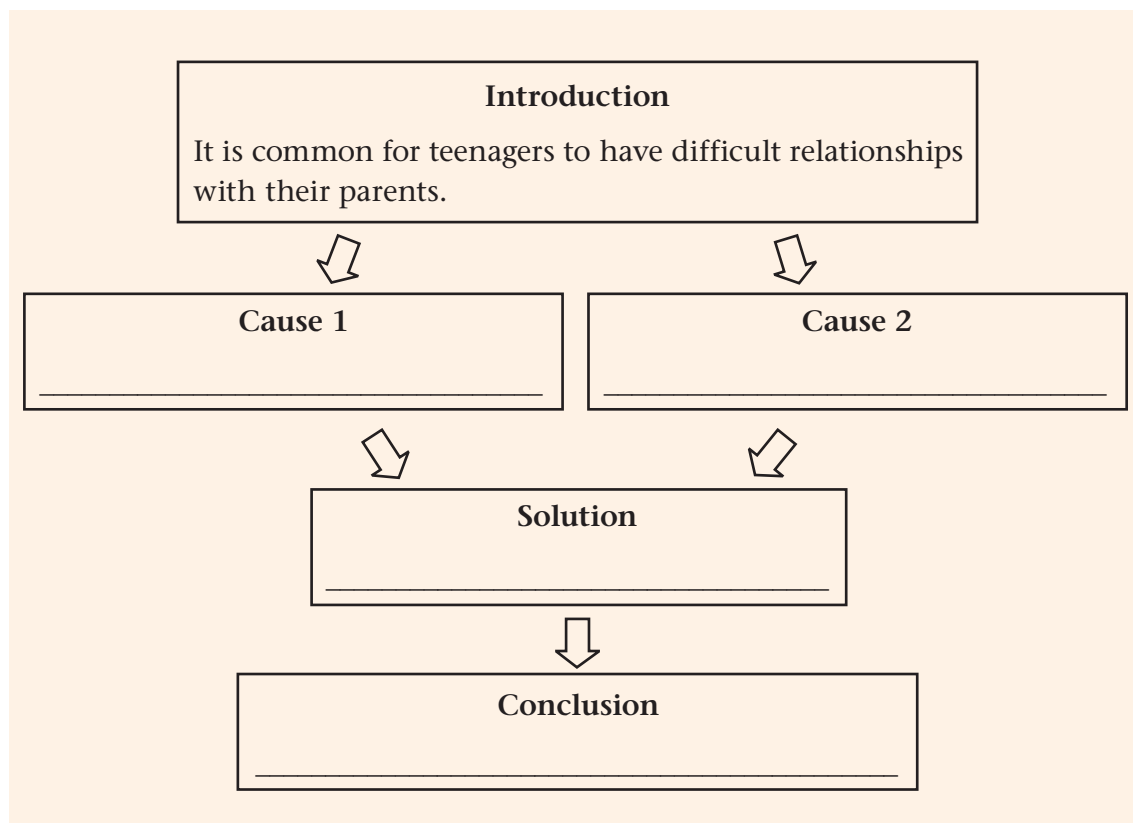
Although sometimes it may seem impossible to get along as a family, you can take action to improve the situation. The key to keeping the peace is regular and honest communication. When you disagree with your parents, take a minute to calm down and try to understand the situation from their point of view. Perhaps they have experienced something similar and do not want you to go through the same pain. After you have thought it through, explain your actions and feelings calmly, listen carefully, and address their concerns. Through this kind of healthy discussion, you will learn when to back down and when to ask your parents to relax their control.

Just remember that it is completely normal to struggle with the stress that parent-child tensions create, and that you and your parents can work together to improve your relationship. The good news is that this stormy period will not last. Everything will turn out all right in the end, and the changes and challenges of your teenage years will prepare you for adulthood.



A Understanding the text

A1 Read the magazine article and complete the chart below.



A2 Read the magazine article again carefully and answer the following questions.

1 What physical changes might teenagers worry about?

2 What does “middle ground” in line 15 mean?

3 What does “that” in “that makes you feel unhappy” in line 19 refer to?

4 How can teenagers have a healthy discussion with their parents?

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1 What is the author’s attitude to parent-child tensions? Use information in the magazine article to support your idea.

2 The magazine article suggests that teenagers want both independence and their parents’ love and support. Do you feel the same way or not? Give an example.

3 What stresses do the parents of a teenager have to deal with? How do they influence the parent-child relationship?

B Building your language

B1 Mrs Zhao wrote an email to a teen magazine. Complete the email with the correct forms of the words and phrases in the box below.

anxious
normal

argument
stress

concern
struggle

calm down
go through

Dear Editor,

I am writing to ask for advice on my relationship with my teenage son. To tell the truth, I often ⁽¹⁾ _____ to get along with him. Recently we have argued with each other a great deal. He is ⁽²⁾ _____ about his skin because it has started to become very oily, with lots of red spots. He is always angry these days and seems less confident. I keep telling him that these changes are ⁽³⁾ _____, and that things will turn out just fine. Of course, I wanted to show my ⁽⁴⁾ _____ for his condition, so I asked him to see a doctor. But then he became angry and we had a big ⁽⁵⁾ _____. He told me that I was putting even more ⁽⁶⁾ _____ on him by talking about his spots all the time. In the end, I sent him to his room. He finally ⁽⁷⁾ _____, but it took some time. The whole experience was really terrible and I do not want to ⁽⁸⁾ _____ the same thing again. What should I do?

Best wishes,
Mrs Zhao

B2 The article uses some abstract nouns. Note the following suffixes and think of more abstract nouns formed with them. Then fill in the table below with as many words as you can.

Parts of speech	Suffixes	Words
Adjectives	-ce	independence
	-ty/-ity	honesty
Nouns	-hood	adulthood
	-ship	relationship
Verbs	-ment	argument
	-tion/-sion	communication
	-th	growth

Tip

Forming abstract nouns

Abstract nouns refer to ideas or qualities. They cannot be physically touched, for example, *ability*, *silence* and *tension*. We can form abstract nouns using certain suffixes. Sometimes the final letter(s) of a word should be left out or changed when we add a suffix, e.g. *silent*→*silence*, *decide*→*decision*.

B3 The magazine article uses a group of questions to introduce the topic of parent-child tensions. Read the first paragraph of the magazine article and introduce the topic of parents' love for their children by asking questions.

Learn this When a group of questions are used to introduce a topic, they are usually not meant to be answered. Rather, the author intends to draw readers' attention to the topic and make them think about and take an interest in it.

Grammar and usage

Simple, compound and complex sentences

A Exploring the rules

Below is an introduction on the home page of a website for teenagers. Match each sentence with the correct type in the table below. Write down the numbers.

(1) We know that being a teenager is sometimes difficult. (2) So, we have designed TeenHealthWeb to help you along the journey to adulthood. (3) Our website has many articles about teenagers' physical and mental health. (4) You can look through these articles to find advice on your problem. (5) It may not have been addressed before, but don't worry. (6) You can visit the "teen health" forum on our website instead. (7) We are proud to say this forum is the heart of our website. (8) Users are encouraged to post their problems, and they will get advice from our health experts and other forum users. (9) Before you write your post, however, take a look at other users' posts first. (10) It is likely that the matter has already been discussed on our forum. (11) If your problem is a new one, write a post about it. (12) Our health experts will be glad to tell you what steps you can take to improve your situation. (13) There is a lot to see, so take some time to look around our website!

Simple sentences	
Compound sentences	
Complex sentences	

Working out the rules

- A simple sentence is made up of one independent clause which has one subject-verb combination.
- A compound sentence contains two or more main clauses. We use linking words such as (1) _____, or, (2) _____, so or for to link the clauses.
- A complex sentence contains one main clause and at least one subordinate clause. A subordinate clause can be the subject, predicative, object, attributive or adverbial of the sentence.

👉 Grammar notes → pages 97–98

B Applying the rules

B1 Below are some tips on how to use TeenHealthWeb. Join each pair of sentences to form a compound or complex sentence.

- 1 Your password should be at least eight characters long. This makes it difficult to guess.

- 2 Posts should not give out personal information. They should not include advertisements.

- 3 Describe your problems clearly. Other people can understand them easily.

- 4 The experts will reply to you. They see your posts.

- 5 What do you think of our forum? Let us know.

B2 Teresa is talking to her friend Jack about her parents. Complete the conversation with the correct linking words in the box below.

and because but how if that unless why

- Teresa:** I'm under a lot of stress these days (1) _____ my parents are always comparing me with my friends. They're never satisfied (2) _____ I do better than all my friends—in schoolwork, in hobbies, in everything!
- Jack:** That's terrible. I can see (3) _____ you're anxious. You should tell your parents (4) _____ you're trying your best. There's no point in comparing you with others all the time. Everyone is unique.
- Teresa:** I know, (5) _____ my parents don't seem to understand that. (6) _____ they continue like this, I'll lose confidence in myself.
- Jack:** I think your parents are too strict with you. Don't take a passive role in the relationship. Talk to them. Let them know (7) _____ you feel. Sometimes, competition can push you to do better. Right now, it's just making you anxious and having a bad influence on your performance.
- Teresa:** Thank you, Jack. I'll try talking to my parents.
- Jack:** Cheer up, Teresa. They'll understand (8) _____ everything will turn out all right!

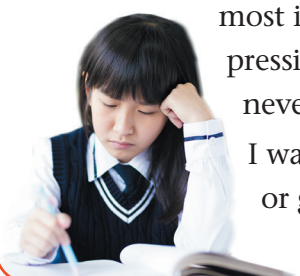
B3 In pairs or groups, role-play a conversation between Teresa and her parent(s) using simple, compound and complex sentences. The beginning has been given.

Teresa: Hi Mum! Can we please talk?
Mother: Sure, dear. What's the matter?
...

Integrated skills

Giving advice on parent-child relationships

A Some teenagers write to Cynthia, the host of a radio programme called Teen Time, about their problems with their parents. Read the parts of their emails below and describe each problem in one sentence.

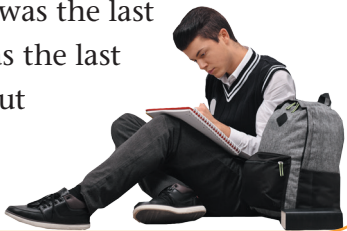


My mum keeps a notebook of my grades in every exam. She asks my teachers how I'm doing at school whenever she can. It seems as if my grades are the most important thing in her life. When we're at home, she keeps pressing me to study all the time. I do as she says, but she is never happy with my grades. Why can't she leave me alone? I want to take a break once in a while. I want to listen to music or go out with my friends. Is that too much to ask for?

—Rebecca

I'm eager for my parents' love. They're always busy at work. I hardly ever see them during the week because they don't get home until late at night. I tell them that I'm stressed about schoolwork, but neither of them show any concern. Sometimes I feel quite lonely at home. When was the last time we had a family outing at the weekend? When was the last time we had a long talk? How can parents not care about their children?

—Simon



Everyone says that youth is a time for adventure, but my parents disagree. I spend most of my spare time at home, because they hardly ever let me go out with my friends. When I do go out, they always ask, "Where are you going?" "Who are you going with?" "What are you going to do?" "When will you be back?" They're always on my back about something.

I understand that they're trying to protect me from getting hurt. However, just as a baby kangaroo must learn to protect itself when it leaves its mother's pocket, I will have to learn to protect myself when I grow up. I wish they could be more flexible so that I can make my own choices about what to do in my spare time.

—Laura



Rebecca's problem	
Simon's problem	
Laura's problem	

B Cynthia is replying to Rebecca's email on the radio programme. Listen and finish the exercises below.



B1 Listen to Cynthia's reply and circle the correct words to complete the sentences below.

- 1 According to Cynthia, Rebecca feels unhappy because her mother does not **understand her/value her effort**.
- 2 Cynthia thinks that every parent has **too much control over/high hopes for** their children.
- 3 According to Cynthia, school and **friendship/relaxation** are both important.
- 4 Cynthia says Rebecca should be **patient/calm** enough to understand what her mother does.
- 5 Cynthia describes her senior high school life as **exciting/tiring**.



B2 Listen to Cynthia's reply again and complete the notes below.

Advice for Rebecca

- (1) _____ your mother. Make sure she understands (2) _____.

➤ Remember to choose (3) _____ and start the conversation politely.

Example: "I know that you expect me to (4) _____, but I'm struggling sometimes. Can we please talk?"

➤ Try to (5) _____. Let your mother know about (6) _____ and ask for more free time.

Example: Try to make a deal with your mother by explaining why you (7) _____ and how it helps you.

- (8) _____ in your mother's shoes and try to understand what she does.

Example: When your mother doesn't let you (9) _____, think about why she does so.

C In pairs, role-play a conversation between Simon/Laura and Cynthia. Try to ask for and give advice. Use the following ideas and expressions to help you.

- Problem Simon/Laura has
- Advice Cynthia gives

Expressions

Asking for and giving advice

- | | |
|---|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Asking for advice <p>What shall I do?</p> <p>What do you think I should do?</p> <p>Do you think that I should ...?</p> <p>Do you have any ideas/suggestions?</p> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Giving advice <p>I suggest that you (should) ...</p> <p>I think/feel you can try ...</p> <p>It might be a good idea to ...</p> <p>How about/What about ...?</p> |
|---|--|

D Write a reply to Simon's or Laura's email. Use your ideas from part C and the information in parts A and B to help you.

Planning your writing

• Learning about the text type

A letter of advice is written to someone who has a problem and does not know how to solve it. In a letter of advice, you try to help solve the problem by offering useful advice.

• Learning about the structure

When you write a letter of advice, you can follow the structure below:

- Start by showing your understanding.
- Offer several pieces of advice to help solve the problem. You can include personal experiences or stories about someone who has had a similar problem.
- End the letter with a positive message. It is a good idea to try to cheer up the person you are writing to.

• Learning about the language

The following expressions might be helpful when you write a letter of advice:

I understand your feelings.

Try these pieces of advice and see if they help.

I hope ... I wish you all the best.

Checking your writing

Remember to check your writing after you finish and exchange drafts between you and your partner. Pay attention to the following aspects:

- | | | |
|--|--|------------------------------------|
| ☐ Punctuation | ☐ Spelling | ☐ Grammar |
| ☐ Choice of words | ☐ Style (formal/informal) | ☐ Structure |

Self-review

- Do the examples support the advice you give?
- What is the sentence you are most satisfied with?

Peer review

- What does your partner think of the advice and examples you give?
- How can you improve your writing?

Extended reading



Read the short story about a mother's love for her children.

Mama and Her Bank Account

Every Saturday night Mama would sit down by the kitchen table and count out the money Papa had brought home.

"For the rent." Mama would count out the big silver pieces.

"For the groceries." Another group of coins.

5 "I'll need a notebook." That would be my sister Christine, my brother Nels or me.

Mama would put one or two coins to the side. We would watch with anxious interest. At last, Papa would ask, "Is that all?" And when Mama nodded, we could relax a little. Mama would look up and smile, "Good. We do not have to go to the Bank." We were all so proud of Mama's Bank Account. It gave us such a warm,
10 secure feeling.

When Nels graduated from grammar school, he wanted to go on to high school. "It will cost a little money," he said.

Eagerly we gathered around the table. I took down a box and laid it carefully in front of Mama. This was the "Little Bank". It was used for sudden emergencies, such
15 as the time when Christine broke her arm and had to be taken to a doctor.

Nels listed the costs of the things he would need. Mama counted out the money in the Little Bank. There was not enough. "We do not want to go to the Bank," she reminded. We all shook our heads.

"I will work in Dillon's grocery after school," Nels volunteered.

20 Mama gave him a bright smile and wrote down a number. "That's not enough," Papa said. Then he took his pipe out of his mouth and looked at it for a long time. "I will give up smoking," he said suddenly.

Mama reached across the table and touched Papa's arm. Then she wrote down another figure.

25 "I will look after the Elvington children every Friday night," I said. "Christine can help me."

Now there was enough money. We all felt very good because we did not have to go downtown and draw money out of Mama's Bank Account.

30 So many things came out of the Little Bank that year: Christine's dress for the school play, my little sister Dagmar's operation ... Whatever happened, we always knew we still had the Bank to depend upon.

35 That was twenty years ago.

Last year I sold my first story. When the check came, I hurried over to Mama's and put it in her lap. "For you," I said, "to put in your Bank Account."

I noticed for the first time how old Mama and Papa looked. Papa seemed shorter, and Mama's hair was silver now.

40 "Tomorrow," I told Mama, "you must take it to the Bank."

"You will go with me, Katrin?"

"That won't be necessary. Just hand it to the teller. He'll pay it into your account."

Mama looked at me. "There is no account," she said. "In all my life, I've never been inside a bank."

45 And when I didn't—couldn't—answer, Mama said seriously, "It is not *good* for little ones to be afraid—to not feel secure."

(Adapted from Kathryn Forbes's *Mama's Bank Account*, which has 17 short stories and describes the struggles and dreams of a family in San Francisco in the early 1900s)

A In pairs, find information about each of the following elements of the short story and complete the table below.

Setting	
Characters	
Plot	
Theme	

Tip

Understanding a short story

A short story has some basic elements: setting, characters, plot and theme. To understand a short story well, the reader needs to analyse all these elements.

B Have your parents done something that has moved you greatly? What was it? Share your story.



Project

Creating a short play about parent-child relationships

A As a class, discuss what topics should be presented for a play about parent-child relationships. You can use the ideas below or think of other ideas. Then in groups, pick one topic for your play.

friends	goals/dreams	hobbies	housework
personal habits	pocket money	schoolwork	...



B As a group, watch a video and then discuss how to write a short play about your chosen topic. Use the table below to help you.

Elements of a play	The play you watch	Your own play
Setting		
Characters		
Plot		
Theme		

C As a group, write your play. Use the example below, which is the beginning of a short play, to help you. Then perform your play in front of the class.

Act 1, Scene 1

Stage directions, written in italics, are often given at the start of a new act/scene to tell the reader when and where the play is set.

Dialogue includes characters and lines. Names of characters appear before new lines.

Friday evening. The living room of a flat. A teenage girl, Eve, is sitting on the sofa and texting on her mobile phone when her dad enters.

Dad: I'm home! *(He waits for a response but doesn't get one. He puts his bag on the table.)* Eve, how was your day?

Eve: Fine. *(She gets up and starts to walk to her room.)*

Dad: Who are you texting?

Eve: No one. *(She continues to text without looking up.)*

Dad: Are you all right?

Eve walks into her room.

Eve: Yeah. *(She shuts the door.)*

Tip

Performing a play

To perform a play well, you should:

- learn how to say your lines: try speaking in different ways, e.g. softly, angrily, to see which way works best;
- perform with confidence and make sure that you can be heard clearly;
- use body language to show your feelings.

Stage directions in the dialogue give instructions on what actions to perform. They are italicized and put in brackets.

UNIT 3

Getting along with others

The glory of friendship is not the outstretched hand, nor the kindly smile, nor the joy of companionship; it is the spiritual inspiration that comes to one when he discovers that someone else believes in him and is willing to trust him.

—Ralph Waldo Emerson



In this unit, you are going to:

- read a forum exchange about a friendship in trouble;
- write a diary entry about the qualities of a good friend;
- read an essay on friendship;
- make a scrapbook about friendship.

Welcome to the unit



Teenagers may have difficulty maintaining their friendships. Watch the video and finish the following exercises.



Bill's problem:

Jane's problem:

Harry's problem:

- 1 What advice can you give these teenagers?
- 2 What friendship problems have you had? Share your experience.

Reading



It is often difficult to start a friendship and even more difficult to keep one. The forum exchange below includes a post written by Amy, a teenage girl who had a problem with her best friend Jenny, and two replies. Before you read the forum exchange, think about the following questions:

- Do you think there are “friends for life”? Why or why not?
- Would you turn to online communities for advice about maintaining friendships? Why or why not?

Friendship on the rocks: please advise!



Amy

Monday 12/10 9:13 p.m.

My best friend and I have been close for eight years. When I was an awkward primary school student, she was the popular girl who was willing to make friends with me. Since then, a close friendship has grown between us and she's been almost like a sister to me. Whether we're walking to school, doing homework or
5 just hanging out at the weekend, we're hardly out of each other's sight. But last Saturday, she broke my heart, and I'm still picking up the pieces.

Our original plan was to see a film at the cinema that afternoon. But in the morning, my friend posted a message on social media saying she had a cold. When I called her, she said she might not be able to make it to the cinema. “Don't worry,” I said.
10 “Get some rest. We can wait till you get better.”

Today, however, I received a horrible surprise. A classmate told me she had seen my friend chatting with another girl in a café on Saturday afternoon. How stupid I was! My friend's “illness” was a complete lie! Instead of recovering at home, she was out having fun with someone else.

15 I was so angry that I avoided her during school all day, and I still don't feel like responding to any of her online messages. The stress of this situation is killing me, and I'm at a loss what to do next.

| 2 | 13

Cindy



Monday 12/10 9:52 p.m.

I'm so sorry! But this friendship is worth saving: eight years is a long time! Don't be so quick to judge your friend. Perhaps she knows she's in the wrong and wants to apologize, or maybe she has a simple explanation for her behaviour. In any case, find an opportunity to have a full and frank talk with her. Listen to what she has to say, and be sure to explain how you feel. I'm sure you can solve this problem together.

|  0 |  3

David



Tuesday 13/10 8:11 p.m.

I definitely understand how you feel. I also had a friend whom I trusted a lot. When I found out that I was tricked by him, I was really hurt and let go of our friendship. I know you value your friendship and want your friend to value it equally. However, if your friend ignores your feelings or makes you suffer, it's time to rethink your relationship. Talk to her and decide whether this friendship is still important to you. It's sad to move on, but you have to accept that friends come and go in life.

|  0 |  3



A Understanding the text

A1 Read the forum exchange and complete the chart below.

Amy's problem	Advice given
● Saturday morning: Amy's friend said she was ill and might not be able to make it to the cinema.	Cindy: (3) _____
● Saturday afternoon: (1) _____	David: (4) _____
● Monday: (2) _____	

A2 Read the forum exchange again carefully and answer the following questions.

1 How did Amy view her friend before?

2 What did Amy and her friend plan to do last Saturday afternoon?

3 How did Amy learn that her friend went to a café?

4 What does Cindy mean by "her behaviour" in line 20?

5 In what case is it time to rethink a friendship, according to David?

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1 What are the similarities and differences between Cindy's and David's advice?

2 What helpful advice can you offer Amy? Draw on your own experiences to give a reply to her post.

3 Imagine your friend has lied to you. How would you respond?